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Culture (OWC): [Chagga \(FN04\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Eastern Africa

Field Date: 1906-1926

Coverage Date: 1900-1926

Place Coverage: Chagga, Tanzania

Section Title(S): 5. Bride-Transfer And Wedding

The parties tear up the soil between them to indicate a trench. Hence the designation for the ceremony: "Lupariane mfo"—"Let us dig up a trench between us." The two elders, with the ditch between them, begin to scold each other violently and to incite each other into a fighting spirit. "You stay where you are, and I stay where I am. We are enemies and have nothing in common anymore." Brandishing his spear the one shouts: "I shall run it into your heart." The other replies: "I shall run it through your liver." The armed fellows support the elders with fighting movements. Finally, one of the elders shouts: "Lumae sonu, via kindo kja sonu, kuiho-se msiki lurentse kifa kjakefo — Let us eliminate the disgrace. Say something disgraceful. There is no sib sister anymore on whose account we would have to be bashful." The other elder follows up with a dirty joke. This is regarded as a very important demonstration to indicate that there are no sisters anymore.

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At the end, one of the elders grabs the young girl from his escort and pushes her over the ditch to the other party while saying: "Here I give you my head of cattle." The other party 164 pushes their girl over the ditch. Each party seizes the girl as if she were part of a loot. Jubilantly they move homeward. The girls are put into the custody of the mother of the young men to whom they had been engaged, and the negotiations about the ngosa may now start.

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The Msaki-sib have made this separation, and the Wamsaki in Moschi and the Wamsaki in Kuruwa are allowed to intermarry.

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The state of being alienated (Fremdschaft) into which they put each other is called maisa or mesa, which nowadays means national enemy. Originally the word meant the distance, the unattainable. "Onduma maisa kundo ndzilesika — You send me abroad to a place where I cannot get to."

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The sib, once it had become exogamous, had to put special emphasis upon the retention of guardianship over the sib member that had been married off. The exchange of sisters is an example for this tendency and its transforming influence. ■ 144 If each one of two men marries the sister of the other, special precautions have to be observed to banish the dangers threatening from such cross-match. As the brother of the wife each one is the master over the other. But in insisting on his rights he endangers himself as the husband of the other's sister. Here the currents of life intertwine at high tension — one needs only be reminded of the mtsuko influence, dealt with elsewhere — so that the existence of chaos at one point may have disastrous consequences for all concerned.

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